Builders Ready: Business Plan

Operating plan and investment overview

Builders Ready Ltd · Company no. 17551960

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Executive summary

Builders Ready is a UK software product that runs the whole building job for a trade, from the first quote to the final payment, and then feeds that trade more work through a built-in marketplace. It is live and paying today on iOS, Android and the web.

The problem is simple and large. UK building work still runs on texts, paper and trust: quoting at 9pm, chasing invoices, arguments over what was agreed, and, for homeowners, no safe way to find a builder or see what is happening once work starts. The job-management tools that exist ignore the client, and the lead sites just sell leads. Nobody joins the whole job up.

Builders Ready joins it up. A builder quotes on site, the client accepts and signs on their phone, the job runs on a live timeline with photos and signed decisions, and staged payments land by card, bank or cash straight to the builder. A homeowner-facing marketplace lets people post jobs and trades quote them, with no per-lead fee. Every builder gets the whole thing under their own brand.

The product is finished and in builders' hands. The company (Builders Ready Ltd) is incorporated, the infrastructure and billing sit under it, and the founder has funded the build himself. The opportunity now is distribution: there are roughly 885,000 construction SMEs in the UK, around 78% of them sole traders, and the market is almost entirely unserved by anything that does all of this in one place and prices it for a team rather than per seat.

The plan is to grow a base of paying trades region by region off a near-free content engine (short video plus an email list) amplified by a disciplined marketing budget, reach around 500 paying subscribers inside twelve months and around 1,500 in year two (roughly £0.8m to £1.0m of annual recurring revenue), with marketplace and payment fees as a second revenue line on top. To accelerate that, the company is raising £50,000 for 20% equity, with every pound going into distribution rather than build.

The problem

Building work runs on chaos, on both sides of the job.

For the builder, the admin eats the evenings and the margin. Quotes get written late at night, invoices get chased by text, agreements live in WhatsApp threads, and when a client says “I never agreed to that,” there is nothing to point to. The tools meant to help are either US-built and priced in dollars, or they are tradesperson invoicing apps that stop at the quote, or they are job-management systems that treat the client as an afterthought.

For the homeowner, there is no easy way to find a trustworthy trade, no visibility once the work starts, and a real fear of paying a deposit to someone who disappears. That fear is the single biggest reason good jobs stall and good builders lose work to whoever shouts loudest.

And the tools today make it worse, not better. Job-management apps ignore the client entirely. Lead sites sell the same lead to five builders and charge for the privilege. Nobody connects winning the work, running the job, keeping the client happy and getting paid into one place. More than £140bn of UK building work a year still runs on texts, paper and trust.

The product

Builders Ready is not a concept or a prototype. It is a finished product, shipping now, feature-complete across the core job lifecycle and live on three platforms.

What is already built and in use:

- **On-site quoting and estimates.** Build a costed quote on site from trade templates with current, cited material prices, add your margin, choose exactly what the client sees (every line, subtotals, or a single total), produce a branded PDF, and have the client accept and e-sign from their phone. A won quote becomes a managed project in one tap.
- **Live client portal.** The client gets a clean portal under the builder’s brand: the project timeline, site photos, progress, decisions to approve, and invoices to pay. The same picture on web and mobile, so nothing is ever out of sync.
- **Signed decisions and variations.** Every change is priced and signed on the client’s phone, auto-numbered and locked once agreed. This is the dispute killer.
- **Contracts and staged payments.** Turn an accepted quote into a signable contract with a staged payment schedule (deposit, stages, completion, retention held to snagging). Raise an invoice on any milestone in a tap.
- **Get paid, in-app.** Payments by card (through Stripe, straight to the builder’s own account), bank transfer or cash, chosen per invoice. A flat £3 per card payment, never a percentage, and free on the top tier.
- **Cost, margin and handover.** Log costs on site, see live margin against the contract value (team-only, never shown to the client), and produce a one-tap handover PDF at the end.
- **Planning Radar.** Shows a builder building work being planned near them the moment it hits the public planning record, sorted by distance, with a tap to turn a listing into a quote or draft a letter to the occupier. It is live across the UK and refreshed daily.

- **A two-sided marketplace.** Homeowners post jobs, trades quote them, both sides review each other, and there is no per-lead fee.

Every builder runs all of this under their own logo and colours, on the phone in their pocket and the laptop in the office.

Market opportunity

Construction is the UK's biggest small-business sector, and it is almost entirely made up of exactly the customer Builders Ready is built for.

- **Around 885,000 construction SME businesses** operate in the UK.
- **Approximately 78% are sole traders** with no employees, and **99% of the sector are small businesses.**
- **More than £140bn** of building work a year still runs on texts, paper and trust.

The competitive middle is empty. The closest functional products (Buildertrend, BuildBook, Houzz Pro) are US-built, dollar-billed and priced per seat, and they feel transplanted. The closest UK products (Powered Now, Tradify, YourTradebase, Joblogic) sit a category lower: tradesperson invoicing and job cards, not a real client portal with signed decisions and staged payments. The one UK product in the same architectural space, Housebuilder Pro, targets volume housebuilders at roughly £490 per user per month, a different buyer entirely. No one currently owns the sentence "the UK-native app that runs the whole job and brings you the work, priced by project, not per head."

The wedge is straightforward. Capturing a small fraction of hundreds of thousands of small trades is a large business. At Builders Ready pricing, around 1,500 paying subscribers is roughly £0.8m to £1.0m of annual recurring revenue, and the marketplace and in-app payments add a second, scalable revenue line on top of that.

Business model and pricing

Builders Ready earns recurring subscription revenue, priced for teams rather than per seat, with two additional revenue lines (payment fees and the marketplace) layered on top.

Tier
Starter
Pro
Unlimited

Every feature is on every tier. Annual billing saves two months. All prices are quoted excluding VAT, in line with UK B2B convention. There is no free tier: the wedge is a 14-day trial with a card on file.

The pricing is a genuine differentiator. Almost every competitor charges per user seat; Builders Ready charges per active project. A five-person firm pays one flat price, not five. Once a team is larger than three people, per-project billing is cheaper than per-seat, and that is the buying conversation.

The second and third revenue lines:

- **In-app payments.** A flat £3 per card payment (free on Unlimited), never a percentage, so the builder keeps their money and the platform earns a predictable, transparent fee.
- **The marketplace.** Homeowners post jobs and trades quote them with no per-lead fee, a sharp wedge against lead sites that charge £100 to £500 a month. It drives subscriptions (a reason to join) today and becomes a scalable revenue line as volume grows.

Because the product is already built, gross margin is high (around 85%+ SaaS gross margin) and each new subscriber drops close to straight to the bottom line.

Traction

Early, but real, and growing.

- **9 paying subscribers**: live, paying trades, not a waitlist.
- **Around one new sign-up per day**, growing steadily since the founder began posting on TikTok.
- **A feature-complete core**: quote to build to paid, end to end, on three platforms.
- **Planning Radar is live nationwide**, carrying thousands of current planning listings across hundreds of UK local authorities and refreshed by an automated daily job.
- **A content and email engine already running**: short video across TikTok, Instagram Reels and LinkedIn, plus a growing prospect email list sent through the company's own verified domain.

The live metrics above should be refreshed from the founder dashboard (now built and connected) at the point this plan is circulated, so any investor sees current numbers rather than a snapshot.

Competitive landscape

The honest competitive position is that no single competitor joins up software, payments and leads, and that is exactly the gap Builders Ready sits in.

Capability
Client portal and signed decisions
Staged payments and retention
Lead marketplace included

Job management

Priced for teams (not per seat)

Against the US incumbents (Buildertrend from ~£267/mo, BuildBook, Houzz Pro), Builders Ready wins on price, on being UK-native (sterling billing, bank transfer, UK VAT, UK data residency, no US lien language) and on a client app that does not feel imported. Against the UK invoicing and job-card tools, it wins by actually giving the client a real app and by joining payments and leads into the same place. The defensible position is ownership of the whole lifecycle plus the leads that fill it, not any single feature.

Go-to-market

The marketing strategy is covered in full in the separate marketing plan; in summary:

- **Trades first, homeowners later.** Trades pay the subscriptions, so every marketing pound chases a paying trade. Homeowner demand is valuable only once an area has enough trades to answer it, so the marketplace is used as a reason trades subscribe rather than a consumer campaign to fund.
- **One hook above all: Planning Radar.** "Builders Ready finds you building jobs before they are advertised" is sharper and more native than "job-management software," and no competitor has it.
- **Concentrate geographically.** A modest budget spread across the UK is invisible; focused on one or two regions it builds visible density (reviews, word of mouth, marketplace liquidity, and Planning Radar actually having nearby jobs).
- **Organic-led, paid-amplified.** The content engine (short video plus email) is already built and nearly free. Paid budget amplifies what works and retargets interest, rather than carrying cold reach alone.
- **Measure to a real cost of acquisition.** The first 90 days are about learning the true cost to acquire a paying trade and getting it under a third of lifetime value, so the same budget then scales predictably.

Operations

Builders Ready runs lean by design. The product is built on a modern, low-overhead stack (a Next.js web app, a React Native mobile app, and a Supabase backend, hosted on Vercel, with Stripe for payments and Resend for email), all owned and billed under Builders Ready Ltd. Running infrastructure costs are modest (roughly £90 to £120 a month at current scale), and because the product is already built, new revenue is almost pure margin.

Development continues at pace using an AI-assisted workflow that lets a single founder ship production features across web and mobile quickly. Deployments are automated (web through Vercel on every commit, mobile through over-the-air updates), so the cost and time to ship improvements is low.

Team and key-person risk

Builders Ready is founded and run by **Oddie Mehraj**, sole founder and director. He left a paying contract to build the company full-time, funded the build and infrastructure out of his own pocket, and has taken the product from a rough trial to finished, shipping software on three platforms.

The honest risk for a solo-founder business is key-person dependency, and the plan addresses it deliberately: the product, architecture and processes are being documented so the business is not only in one person's head, critical accounts are moving off personal logins onto the company, and the first use of growth capital and early revenue is to begin building repeatable processes and, in time, a small team. An investor is explicitly sought as a hands-on partner (ideas, network and introductions), not just a cheque, which further reduces single-person risk.

Financials and projections

The model is simple: high-margin recurring revenue on a low fixed-cost base, with two secondary revenue lines.

Unit economics (planning assumptions, to be confirmed against live data):

- Blended ARPU across the three tiers of approximately **£50 per month** (£600 per year).
- SaaS gross margin of approximately **85%**.
- Target cost to acquire a paying trade (CAC) with **payback inside three to four months** and **CAC below one third of lifetime value**.

Illustrative growth trajectory:

Milestone	Paying subscribers	Approx. ARR	Notes
Today	9	-	Live, paying, growing ~1/day
12-month goal	~500	~£0.3m	Off the content engine plus focused paid spend
Year two	~1,500	~£0.8m to £1.0m	Plus marketplace and payment-fee revenue on top

These figures are illustrative and depend on growth milestones being met; they are not guaranteed. The point of the model is the shape, not the decimal places: because the product is finished, overheads stay low, so revenue added from here is close to pure margin and the business reaches profitability at a modest subscriber count.

A note on tax, for planning only (not advice): as a UK company sale or future exit is a long-term possibility, the founder intends to discuss Business Asset Disposal Relief and share structure with the company's accountant early, since the qualifying conditions are time-based.

The ask

Builders Ready is raising £50,000 for 20% of the company.

The hard part is done. The product is finished, it is live on three platforms, and paying customers are on it. What has not yet happened, at scale, is telling trades it exists. Every pound of the £50,000 goes into distribution, not build:

- **Google and paid search**, to put Builders Ready in front of trades actively looking for a better way to run jobs.
- **Creator promotions**, paid partnerships with trusted, large-following construction voices who reach the right audience directly.
- **Expos and events**, homeowner and construction trade shows where trust is won face to face and sign-ups happen.

The investor gets 20% equity in a finished, revenue-generating SaaS, a share of the profits as it scales and of any exit, and a hands-on seat for the ride. Illustrative returns, based on target valuations if growth milestones are met and not guaranteed, range from a £1.5m valuation (a 6x return on the 20% stake) to a £3m valuation at around 1,500+ subscribers (a 12x return). Final structure to be agreed with the investor.

Key risks and mitigations

- **Distribution risk (will trades find and adopt it?).** Mitigated by a near-free content engine already producing results, geographic concentration to build density, and a disciplined test-and-learn budget that cuts what does not pay back.
- **Key-person risk (solo founder).** Mitigated by documentation, moving accounts onto the company, and using early capital and revenue to build process and a small team.
- **Competitive response.** Mitigated by the joined-up position (software plus payments plus leads) that no incumbent currently holds, and by UK-native product depth that is costly for a US player to replicate well.
- **Marketplace liquidity (two-sided cold start).** Mitigated by concentrating on one region at a time so trades and homeowner demand reach critical mass locally before widening.
- **Regulatory and tax detail (CIS, VAT, data protection).** Mitigated by framing compliance features as "helps you stay on top of," confirming rules against official sources before building, and keeping the company GDPR-aligned with UK data residency.

Appendix: figures to confirm before circulating

- Live subscriber count, MRR, churn and trial-to-paid conversion: pull from the founder dashboard at time of sending.
- Market figures (885,000 SMEs, 78% sole traders, £140bn) were verified during the deck build; re-confirm the source date if the plan is sent more than a few months from now.
- Competitor pricing changes frequently; re-verify before quoting publicly.